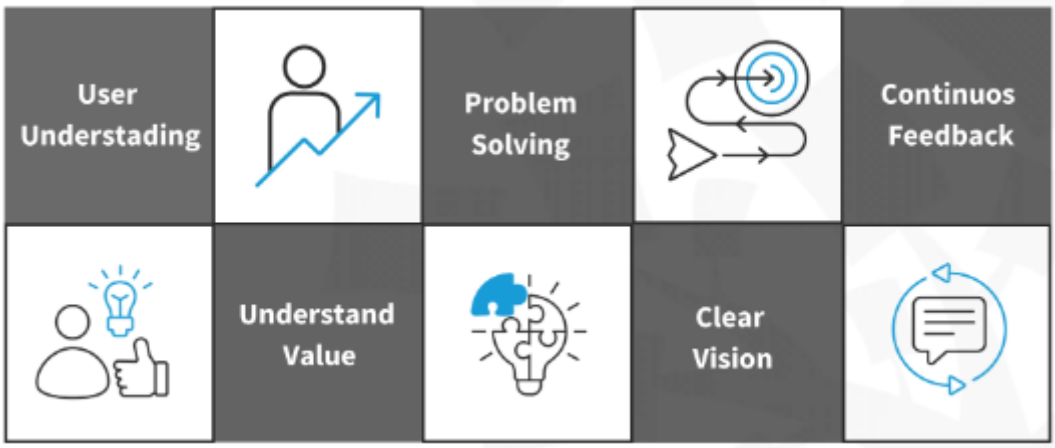


FONTYS VENLO UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES

UX Interventions and Strategies Document: SOFA Project CRM

Semester 7 Software Factory project (2023-2024)



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1. Introduction

This document outlines the necessary User Experience (UX) interventions and strategies to improve the SOFA Project CRM. The goal is to optimize user interactions, improve overall satisfaction, and align with the project's goals of efficiency and user centricity.

2. Current UX Landscape

The SOFA Project CRM currently exhibits a user experience that requires focused intervention for optimization. An in-depth analysis reveals specific pain points and areas for improvement, providing valuable insight into user interactions and system performance.

2.1. Pain points

1) **Navigation complexity:**

Users face challenges navigating the CRM interface, resulting in a suboptimal user experience. Complex menu structures and unclear pathways contribute to confusion and impact overall user satisfaction. (Kitch, 2023)

2) **Inefficient data entry:**

Data entry processes are perceived as time-consuming and error-prone, reducing the efficiency of CRM users. Users express frustration with the lack of intuitive data entry capabilities, which hinders the seamless completion of tasks. (Kitch, 2023)

3) **Limited personalization:**

The current CRM lacks personalized features tailored to individual user preferences and workflows. Users express a desire for customizable dashboards and settings to improve their overall user experience. (Kitch, 2023)

3. Goals and Objectives

The goals and objectives of the UX interventions for the SOFA Project CRM extend to specific enhancements aimed at creating an intuitive and user-friendly experience. These objectives are aligned with the overall project goals while addressing user needs and improving overall system efficiency.

3.1. Goals

1) **Increase user efficiency:**

- Streamline navigation and data entry processes to reduce the time and effort required for users to complete tasks.
- Implement features that promote efficient workflows and allow users to interact seamlessly with the CRM.

2) **Improve user understanding:**

- Develop personalized dashboards and settings to increase user engagement and understanding of CRM functionality.
- Provide clear tooltips and guides to help users effectively navigate the CRM interface.

3) **Streamline user onboarding:**

- Address the learning curve by creating comprehensive training materials and resources for new and existing users.
- Implement easy-to-use features that facilitate a smoother onboarding experience and reduce barriers to CRM adoption.

3.2. Objectives

1) **Clean and simple forms:**

Design and implement clean and simple forms for data entry across all entities within the CRM. Maintain a consistent layout for forms, which promotes user familiarity and reduces errors when entering information.

2) **Searchable overviews:**

Implement summary pages or sections for each entity type, allowing users to quickly access information about existing customers or related entities. Implement a robust filtering system to facilitate efficient searches, allowing users to find specific customers or entities based on defined criteria.

3) **All relevant information on a single page:**

Optimize entity pages to display all relevant information on a single page for a better user experience. Categorize information hierarchically, presenting general details first and offering sections for specific details and related entities.

4. Intervention strategies

The planned UX interventions for SOFA Project CRM are strategically designed to address specific pain points and improve overall user satisfaction. Each intervention is carefully identified, prioritized and described based on its potential impact and feasibility. Both short-term and long-term strategies are considered to ensure a comprehensive and phased approach to improvement.

4.1. Clean and simple forms

Description: Design and implement user-friendly forms for data entry across all entities within the CRM. Prioritize clarity, simplicity, and consistency in layout.

Examples:

- **Consistent layout:** Ensure that form layouts maintain a consistent structure to reduce cognitive load for users.
- **Intuitive input fields:** Implement intuitive input fields with clear labels and placeholders to guide users effectively.

(Smith, 2019)

4.2. Searchable Overviews

Description: Enhance summary pages or sections for each entity type, allowing users to quickly access information. Implement a robust filtering system for efficient searching.

Examples:

- **Dynamic Filters:** Provide dynamic filters that change based on entity type, allowing users to refine searches based on specific criteria.
- **Sortable columns:** Allow users to sort browse pages by relevant columns for quick access to desired information.

(Smith, 2019)

4.3. All Relevant Information on a Single Page

Description: Optimize entity pages to display comprehensive information in a user-friendly manner.

Examples:

- **Hierarchical information display:** Categorize information hierarchically, presenting general details first and offering collapsible sections for more specific details.
- **Clickable sections:** Make sections clickable for a seamless transition to detailed information, creating a smooth navigation experience.

(Smith, 2019)

4.4. Personalized Dashboards

Description: Develop customizable dashboards for users to customize their CRM interface based on preferences and job roles.

Examples:

- **Widget customization**: Allow users to add, remove, or rearrange widgets on their dashboard to create a personalized layout.
- **Saved Layouts**: Allow users to save and switch between different dashboard layouts to meet different needs.

(Smith, 2019)

4.5. Clear Tooltips and Guides

Description: Provide clear tooltips and guides throughout the CRM interface to help users navigate effectively.

Examples:

- **Interactive Tooltips**: Implement tooltips that appear on hover to provide instant guidance on specific functionality.
- **Contextual Guidance**: Provide contextual guidance messages to assist users based on their current actions.

4.6. Incremental Implementation Plan

Description: Implement changes incrementally, starting with high-impact, low-complexity actions before moving on to larger enhancements.

Examples:

- **Phase 1 - Form Redesign**: Begin by redesigning data entry forms to immediately address usability concerns.
- **Phase 2 - Dashboard customization**: Introduce personalized dashboards in a later phase for a smoother transition.

4.7. Continuous monitoring and iteration

Description: Establish a framework for continuous monitoring of user feedback and system performance to enable iterative improvements over time.

Examples:

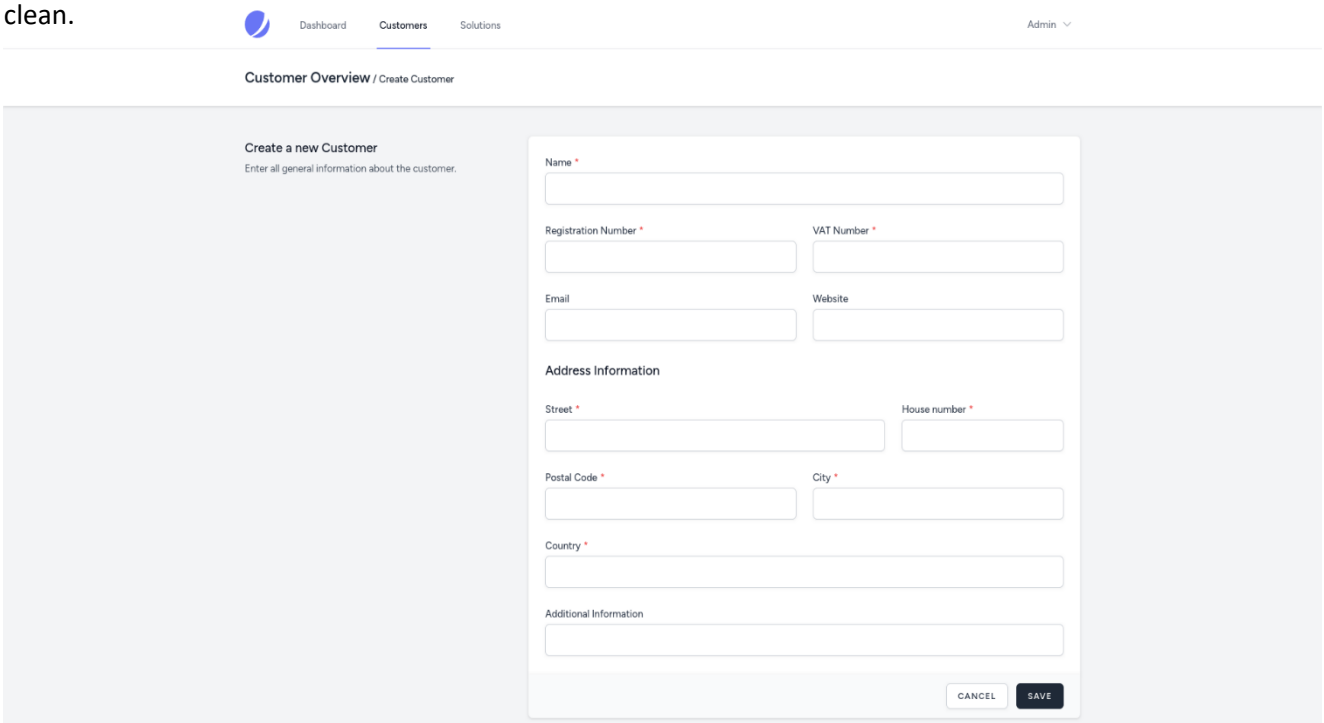
- **Feedback Loops**: Implement mechanisms for users to provide feedback directly within the CRM interface.
- **Regular Usability Testing:** Conduct regular usability testing sessions to identify evolving user needs and pain points.

The chosen intervention strategies take a comprehensive approach, combining immediate improvements with a long-term vision for sustainable user satisfaction and efficiency. Each strategy is tailored to address specific aspects of the UX landscape, ensuring that the overall transformation is impactful, feasible, and responsive to user needs.

5. Wireframes

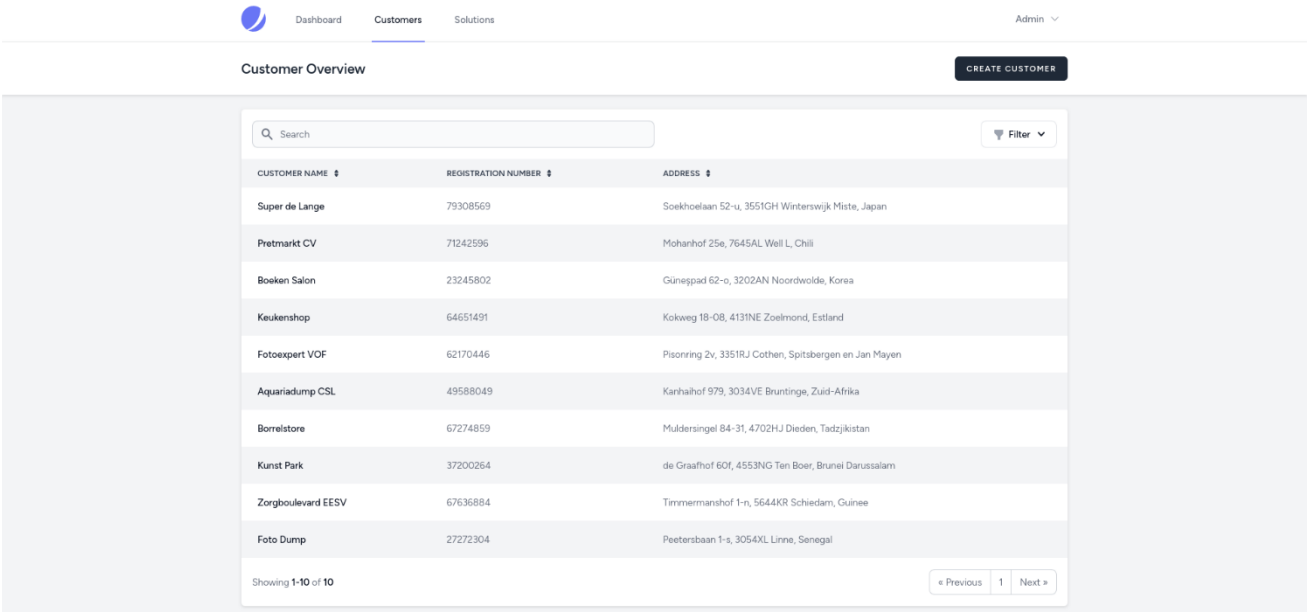
We designed our Wireframes it is a visual representation and shows the goals and objectives we had in mind.

In wireframe 1 you can see **Clean and Simple Forms** it was designed to make it simple, intuitive and clean.



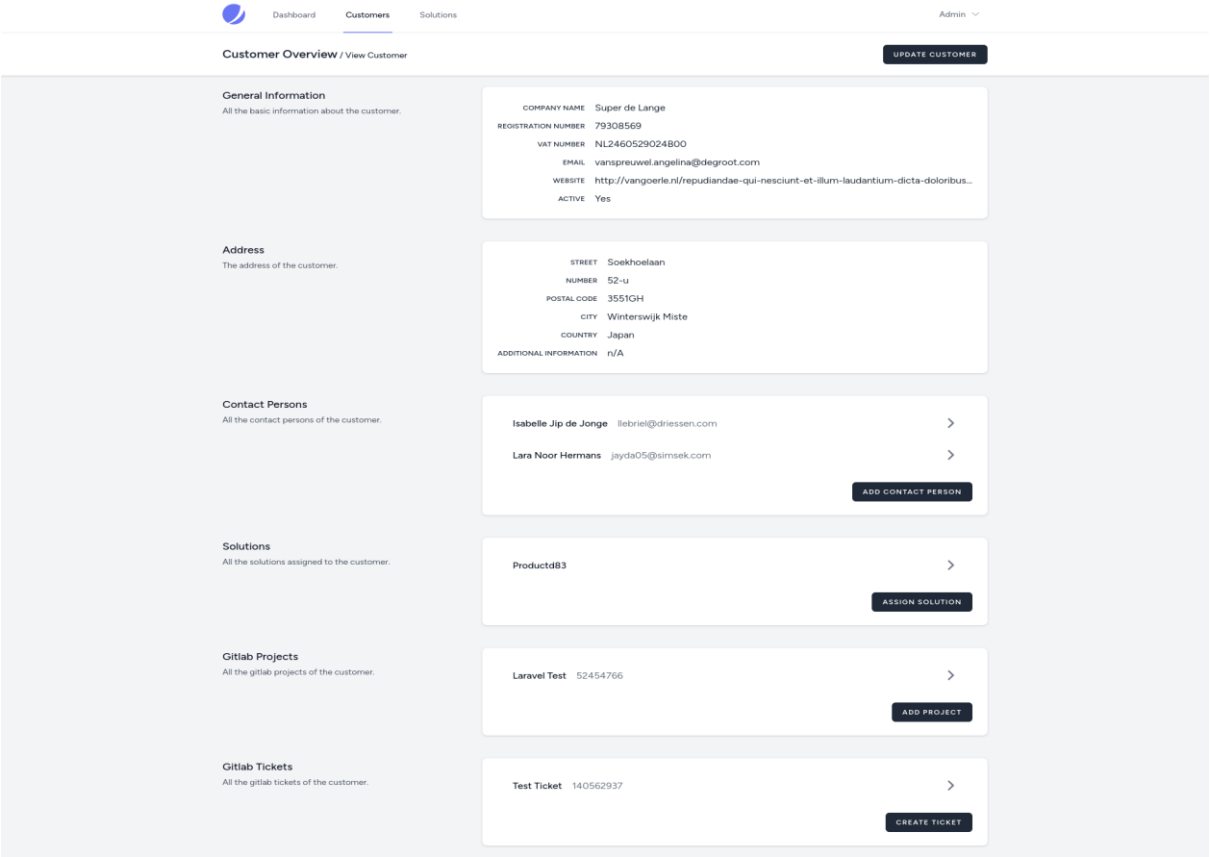
Wireframe 1: Create customer

In wireframe 2 you can see **Searchable overviews** you can easily search for an entity and filter on different categories.



Wireframe 2: Customer overview

In wireframe 3 you can see **All relevant information on a single page** it gives a nice overview of all relevant information.



Wireframe 3: View customer

6. Reasoning for Choosing this Approach

The decision to create a comprehensive UX intervention and strategy document for the SOFA Project CRM was based on several key considerations:

6.1. Alignment with Project Goals

The document is designed to closely align with the overarching goals of the SOFA project, which emphasize efficiency and user-centricity. By addressing the current UX landscape, setting clear goals, and outlining specific objectives, the document serves as a roadmap for achieving project success.

6.2. User-centric approach

Focusing on the current UX landscape provides a user-centric approach that acknowledges existing pain points and areas for improvement. By outlining goals and objectives focused on increasing user efficiency, improving user understanding, and streamlining user onboarding, the document emphasizes the importance of a positive user experience.

6.3. Detailed analysis of the current UX landscape

The in-depth analysis of the current UX landscape, highlighting specific challenges such as navigation complexity, inefficient data entry, and limited personalization, serves as the foundation for targeted interventions. This in-depth review ensures that the proposed strategies directly address the identified pain points.

6.4. Inclusion of stakeholder perspectives

By incorporating user feedback and considerations from people of AppComm, the document reflects a collaborative and inclusive approach. This ensures that the proposed interventions directly address the needs and preferences of end users, thereby increasing the likelihood of successful implementation.

6.5. Visual representation through wireframes

The inclusion of wireframes adds a visual dimension to the document by providing concrete representations of the proposed changes. This visual aid helps stakeholders, including designers and developers, better understand the intended results and facilitates more effective communication of design decisions.

7. Conclusion

In concluding the UX interventions and strategies for the SOFA CRM project, we envision a transformative journey towards an enhanced and user-centric experience. The comprehensive analysis of the current UX landscape revealed specific challenges and laid the foundation for targeted interventions.

Through clearly articulated goals and objectives, we aim to usher in a new era of user efficiency, understanding, and seamless onboarding. The collaborative effort that incorporates stakeholder perspectives and user feedback ensures that the proposed changes meet the needs and preferences of our end users.

The visual representation of wireframes not only serves as a advise for designers and developers, but also symbolizes our commitment to incremental improvement. Clean and simple forms, searchable overviews, and consolidated information on a single page encapsulate our strategy for creating a more intuitive and efficient CRM.

As we begin the implementation phase, we recognize that this is not just a technical upgrade, but a journey toward user empowerment. Documenting the design rationale ensures transparency and fosters a shared understanding of the "why" behind each decision.

In summary, this approach is used to create a comprehensive, user-centric, and visually supported roadmap for improving the UX of the SOFA Project CRM. The document is intended to advise the project team in implementing targeted interventions that directly address identified pain points and align with the broader project goals.

8. References

Kitch, B. (2023, February 2). *Mural*. Opgehaald van How to Identify Pain Points in the User Experience [+ Templates]: https://www.mural.co/blog/identify-user-pain-points

Smith, C. H. (2019, September 1). *Medium*. Opgehaald van Design Interventions — (Prototyping User Experience 2/3): https://medium.com/@careyhillsmith/design-interventions-76a8d1827ad7